

MEMORANDUM

Enterprise PMO · Northgate Financial Group

|       |                                                                              |          |                   |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------------------|
| TO:   | Portfolio Steering Committee                                                 | DATE:    | February 28, 2026 |
| FROM: | Enterprise PMO                                                               | VERSION: | 1.0               |
| RE:   | Solution Architect Resource Constraint — Decision Required by March 22, 2026 |          |                   |

ISSUE

The Solution Architect role (currently Wei L.) is the portfolio's most constrained resource at **142% utilization** during Q1–Q2 2026. Three active projects — **Data Centre Migration (D005)**, **Branch Network Refresh (D011)**, and **Cloud Infrastructure Ph.1 (D014)** — are all drawing on this single resource simultaneously. Combined demand during the Jan–Apr overlap period reaches 40 hrs/week against an effective capacity of 28.1 hrs/week — an overload of 11.9 hrs/week.

IMPACT

**Enterprise Risk Dashboard (P005)** is currently **Red** at 9 weeks schedule delay, partly attributable to architect availability. **Data Centre Migration (P002)** and **Cloud Infrastructure Ph.1 (P010)** are both at risk of schedule slippage if the constraint is not addressed before their peak demand periods (Apr–Jun 2026 for both). If no decision is made, at least one of these projects will slip.

OPTIONS ANALYSED

- Option A — Approve contract Solution Architect for Q2 (Apr–Jun 2026).**

Estimated cost: \$80K. Resolves overload immediately. No project delays. Recommended if \$80K is within Q2 contingency budget.
- Option B — Defer Cloud Infrastructure Ph.1 start by 8 weeks to July 2026.**

Cost: nil. Reduces Q2 overload entirely. P010 go-live risk shifts later in the year. Recommended if Q2 budget is constrained.
- Option C — Reallocate Wei L. to P005 exclusively until completion (est. May 2026).**

Cost: nil. Resolves P005 Red status. Defers D005 and D011 architect activities — both projects accept schedule risk. Not recommended as a first choice.

PMO RECOMMENDATION

PMO recommends Option A or Option B. Option A is preferable if the \$80K is within Q2 contingency budget. Option B is preferable if Q2 budget is constrained. Either option must be decided by March 22, 2026 — the date P010 start preparation begins. Option C is available as a fallback but carries delivery risk on two projects.

DECISION REQUIRED

**Approve Option A (contract hire at \$80K) or Option B (defer P010 by 8 weeks). Decision owner: CTO. If no decision is received by March 22, 2026, both Data Centre Migration and Cloud Infrastructure will compete for**

Wei L. from April and one project will slip — creating a further Red escalation in the April portfolio report.

| Project                          | Role Demand<br>(hrs/wk) | SA Capacity<br>(hrs/wk) | Overload | Status     |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------|----------|------------|
| Data Centre Migration (D005)     | 25                      | 28.1                    | —        | Confirmed  |
| Branch Network Refresh (D011)    | 15                      | 28.1                    | —        | Confirmed  |
| Cloud Infrastructure Ph.1 (D014) | 20                      | 28.1                    | —        | Forecast   |
| TOTAL (Jan–Apr overlap)          | 40                      | 28.1                    | +11.9    | OVERLOADED |

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